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Steward sues vendors to get payments back

Effort targets firms that still await thousands of dollars owed by bankrupt hospital chain

By Jessica Bartlett

GLOBE STAFF

By early 2024, Steward Health Care owed Brewster Ambulance nearly \$700,000 for the many rides the company provided between Steward's hospitals and to discharge patients.

In the months leading up to its bankruptcy filing in May 2024, Steward managed to pay almost \$170,000 toward its tab.

Now, Steward is suing Brewster to

get that money back.

The lawsuit is one of over 170 the bankrupt health system filed since April 11, seeking to claw back millions of dollars from vendors in Massachusetts and beyond. The lawsuits allege that Steward prioritized paying some vendors over others before the bankruptcy and that payments to those groups over other creditors was a preferential treatment. To those companies, it's one last kick from a former

\$2.8 million

Amount that Steward Health Care is trying to claw back in Massachusetts

business partner.

"In my eyes, you not only took advantage of me for a number of years and I hung in to make sure the patients we care for weren't affected by your lack of payment," said Mark Brewster, chief executive of Brewster Ambulance. "Now you want to claw back the little bit you did give me? I'm furious."

The lawsuits against vendors stand in contrast to what the company so far

STEWART, Page A10

Hegseth reportedly shared attack plan

Latest Signal chat group included wife and brother, according to sources

By Greg Jaffe, Eric Schmitt, and Maggie Haberman

NEW YORK TIMES

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth shared detailed information about forthcoming strikes in Yemen on March 15 in a private Signal group chat that included his wife, brother, and personal lawyer, according to four people with knowledge of the chat.

Some of those people said the information Hegseth shared on the Signal chat included the flight schedules for the F/A-18 Hornets targeting the Houthis in Yemen — essentially the same attack plans that he shared on a separate Signal chat the same day that mistakenly included the editor of The Atlantic.

Hegseth's wife, Jennifer, a former Fox News producer, is not a Defense Department employee, but she has traveled with him overseas and drawn criticism for accompanying her husband to sensitive meetings with foreign leaders.

Hegseth's brother Phil and Tim Parlatore, who continues to serve as his personal lawyer, both have jobs in the Pentagon, but it is not clear why either would need to know about upcoming

HEGSETH, Page A6

Senator sweeps political mines from Maine

Collins treads carefully between Mills, president

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When President Trump and Governor Janet Mills of Maine sparred at the White House in February over her refusal to comply with his executive order banning transgender girls from girls' sports, it ignited a bitter feud.

And so far, no one has blinked.

But a powerful third figure, thrust uncomfortably into this drama, has become a crucial player: Maine's senior senator, Susan Collins.

While Trump and Mills escalated their conflict in public, Collins intervened behind the scenes to shield the state from Trump's retaliation in several instances, all while maintaining public neutrality and declining to criticize Trump's punitive approach or call out Mills by name.

The veteran Republican senator's strategy re-



Susan Collins



FRANK O'BRIEN/GLOBE STAFF/1975

SAME 26.2 MILES, VERY DIFFERENT RACE

Four-time winner Rodgers reflects on that first taste of victory 50 years ago

By John Powers

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Fifty years ago Bill Rodgers, little known beyond his Greater Boston Track Club teammates, took the line in Hopkinton wearing a salvaged singlet and a headband and decided that it was his time to win the Boston Marathon.

"Cool day with a tailwind," he recalled. "I was a Boston College graduate student. I knew the course, I knew the hills. If that's on your side you're going to be hard to beat."

Rodgers broke away at Welles-



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Bill Rodgers still hits the pavement regularly, at 77. His prizes for winning in 1975 included a bowl of canned beef stew. More Marathon coverage, B1, C2.

ley that day, and despite stopping four times for water and once to tie a misbehaving shoelace, he set an American record that shocked himself and everyone else.

"This is absurd," he marveled after winning by two minutes and posting a time of 2 hours, 9 minutes, 55 seconds, smashing the mark set by Ron Hill by 35 seconds — at the time the fifth-fastest marathon ever run. "I can't run that fast."

For his labors, Will Rodgers, as the next day's headlines called him, got the customary amateur reward — a laurel wreath, a medal, and a bowl of canned beef stew.

RODGERS, Page C2

Boston wants patrol officers to carry Tasers

By Dan Glaun

GLOBE STAFF

The Boston Police Department is spending millions of dollars as part of a plan to equip all patrol officers with Tasers — a shift in policy and priorities for a department that rarely deployed the stun guns before.

The department will spend \$8.5 million to buy 1,500 Tasers over the next five years, according to a contract with manufacturer Axon. Until now, it had 70 Tasers, exclusively assigned to special operations units. The purchases come even as violent crime in Boston is near record lows, and as Mayor Michelle Wu recently cautioned city departments to tighten their equipment budgets in preparation for possible federal funding cuts.

The decision to invest in Tasers is based on the experience of the specialized units, which have used them in the field since 2015, Police Commissioner Michael Cox said in a statement to the

TASERS, Page A10

PLAYOFFS ON THE PARQUET



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Riding a strong second half, the Celtics started their title defense at TD Garden with a 103-86 win Sunday over the Orlando Magic. Guard Derrick White, shown getting fouled in the first half, led the Celtics, pumping in 30 points. Game 2 is Wednesday in Boston. C1.



Spring in their steps

Monday: Sun early, then clouds. High 53-58, low 46-51.

Tuesday: Warmer, cloudy. High 68-73, low 45-50.

High tide: 5:45, 6:32.

Sunrise: 5:54. Sunset: 7:33.

Weather and comics, **D4-5**.
Obituaries, **C10**.

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The state has limited enrollment in a program that helps elders stay at home and out of a nursing home. **B1.**

A draft detailed the Trump administration's proposal for an extensive restructuring of the State Department that includes eliminating almost all of its Africa operations. **A2.**

Pope Francis made an appearance at the Easter Mass in St. Peter's Square in the Vatican despite his slow recovery from pneumonia. **A4.**

The Sox again lost to the lowly White Sox. **C1.**

Rescuers sought boy who fell in Merrimack River. **B2.**

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